

Orpheus and Eurydice

The myths claim that the most gifted musician who ever lived was Orpheus [OR-fee-us]. Orpheus was married to the beautiful Eurydice [you-RIH-dih-see], but their happiness was cut short when she was bitten by a serpent and died.



Filled with aching sorrow, Orpheus took his lute and travelled to the Underworld to try and get her back. On the shore of the River Styx, he met the ferryman who rowed dead souls to the gates of Hades' kingdom. Orpheus played a sad song that charmed the ferryman into taking him across the river. At the gates, the watchdog, Cerberus, stood guard. Orpheus lulled the creature to sleep with a lullaby.